Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
Capital Investments
Infrastructure Ontario, 1 Dundas Street West

Re: Senior Planning Advisor

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Planning Advisor position in Capital Investments. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, with a master's degree in transportation engineering. The part of the posting I can speak to most directly is turning project and network information into reports, dashboards and briefing material that people making decisions can rely on.

At the City I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, working with other divisions and consultants whose priorities do not always line up. I analyze network data to work out where capacity is short and what that means for maintenance and capital spending, and I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which replaced a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source. I write the briefing notes and presentations that put issues and options in front of senior staff. Earlier, at Metrolinx, I assessed proposed operating changes in OpenTrack before they were taken forward.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not worked in capital project intake or portfolio management, and I have not done project cost estimation or managed a budget. I have not used Power BI; my dashboard and reporting work has been in Python, GIS tools and Excel. I know stage-gate and complexity-assessment frameworks from reading rather than from practice, and I do not hold a PMP or a P.Eng. I am applying because the planning, data and reporting work is close to what I already do, and I would like to apply it to a broader capital portfolio.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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